

GLOBAL DEMAND • PRODUCT LAUNCHES • PIPELINE SIGNALS

Global Top 25 Peptides

Demand leaders, latest product trends and commercial implications for George

Core finding: two metabolic franchises define near-term growth, while oral delivery, longer dosing intervals and specialist indications expand the next opportunity set.

RESEARCH CUT-OFF	SCOPE	PREPARED FOR	IMPORTANT
18 August 2026	Global regulated products	George stakeholders	Demand ≠ South African authorisation or lawful supply

Demand is concentrated today—but delivery innovation is widening the field

The market combines blockbuster metabolic franchises with durable specialist products and a fast-moving pipeline.

US\$36.5bn

Tirzepatide franchise

Combined 2025 Mounjaro and Zepbound revenue; the strongest verified commercial-growth signal.

DKK127.1bn

Ozempic in 2025

Semaglutide remains globally broad, with injectable and oral formulations and expanding indications.

234m

Linzess capsules

US 2025 demand demonstrates that major peptide volume exists beyond injectable metabolic medicines.

Stakeholder verdict

Prioritise regulated, evidence-backed categories. Do not convert online popularity into procurement before product classification, registration, quality and channel gates are passed.

Four trends shape the next cycle

- Oral peptides extend reach beyond injection-ready patients.
- Weekly and monthly formats compete on convenience.
- Multi-agonists and amylin combinations raise efficacy expectations.
- Rare disease and radioligands create high-value specialist niches.

The ranking measures demand signals—not exact worldwide market share

Public disclosure differs by company, geography and product; a consistent evidence hierarchy is therefore more defensible than false precision.

STEP 01

Verify status

Separate approved medicines, launched products, investigational assets, cosmetics, supplements and unapproved compounds.



STEP 02

Measure scale

Use reported sales, prescription or unit demand, geographic reach and persistence of use.



STEP 03

Assess momentum

Evaluate growth, new indications, formulation innovation, manufacturing investment and launch adoption.



STEP 04

Apply caveats

Adjust for price effects, rare-disease economics, category boundaries and jurisdiction-specific labels.

Evidence priority

Regulators

Official labels

SEC filings

Annual results

Clinical registries

Interpret with discipline

Revenue ≠ physical peptide volume. Clinical importance ≠ commercial scale. Pipeline deal value ≠ patient demand. Global approval ≠ South African authorisation.

The Top 10 combine metabolic blockbusters with durable specialist franchises

#	Molecule / family	Common products	Main demand area	Demand direction
1	Tirzepatide	Mounjaro; Zepbound	Diabetes, obesity, OSA	Exceptional growth
2	Semaglutide	Ozempic; Wegovy; Rybelsus	Diabetes, obesity, CV, CKD, MASH	Very high / expanding
3	Insulin analogues	Glargine, degludec, aspart, lispro	Type 1 and type 2 diabetes	Very high / durable
4	Dulaglutide	Trulicity	Type 2 diabetes	High / declining
5	Octreotide & lanreotide	Sandostatin; Somatuline	NETs, acromegaly	High / durable
6	Lu-177 vipivotide	Pluvicto	Prostate cancer	Very high / +43%
7	Fertility hormones	Gonal-f; Pergoveris; Ovidrel	IVF and reproductive care	High / stable
8	Teduglutide	Gattex; Revestive	Short-bowel syndrome	High-value niche
9	Linacotide	Linzess; Constella	IBS-C and constipation	Very high volume
10	Liraglutide	Victoza; Saxenda; generics	Diabetes; weight management	Legacy / generic shift

Ranks 11–25 show where rare disease, specialty care and new formats are scaling

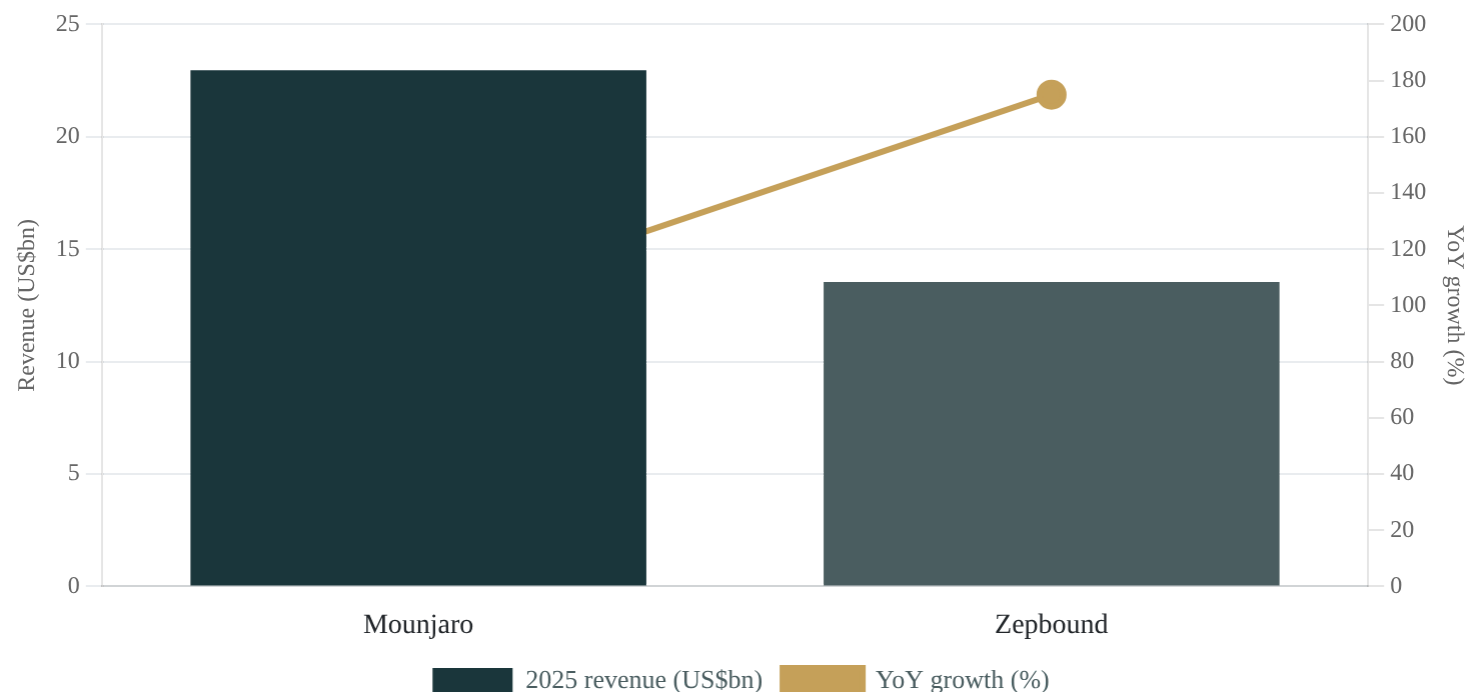
The lower half of the ranking is strategically attractive—but often high-value rather than high-volume.

Ranks 11–15 Established global specialist growth 11 Vosoritide Voxzogo • achondroplasia • US\$927m FY2025 12 Lu-177 dotatate Lutathera • neuroendocrine tumours • growing PRRT 13 Growth-hormone products Daily and weekly formats • convenience shift 14 GnRH agonists Oncology/endocrine depots • stable mature use 15 Palopegteriparatide Yorvipath • rapid rare-disease launch	Ranks 16–20 Mature and high-value specialty products 16 Teriparatide Osteoporosis • multi-source market 17 Bivalirudin Hospital anticoagulation • genericised 18 Voclosporin Lupkynis • lupus nephritis • growing adoption 19 Pasireotide Signifor • rare endocrinology 20 Afamelanotide Scenesse • ultra-rare photoprotection	Ranks 21–25 New launches and emerging adoption 21 Insulin icodec Awicli • first US weekly basal insulin 22 Icodec + semaglutide Kyinsu/IcoSema • weekly combination 23 Elamipretide Forzinity • first Barth syndrome therapy 24 Icotrokinra ICOTYDE • oral IL-23R peptide 25 Navepegritide Yuviwel • weekly achondroplasia therapy
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Tirzepatide sets the growth pace as formats and indications multiply

Scale is being reinforced by oral delivery, weekly dosing, broader outcomes and manufacturing investment.

2025 tirzepatide revenue and reported year-on-year growth



DKK127.1bn

Ozempic sales in 2025

Semaglutide remains broad across diabetes, obesity and outcomes-led indications.

DKK53.1bn

Novo insulin sales in 2025

Essential-use volume remains durable despite pricing and biosimilar pressure.

What changes next

- Oral Wegovy reduces injection friction.
- Weekly insulin raises adherence potential.
- Triple agonists and amylin combinations lift efficacy expectations.

Specialist franchises create durable value outside obesity and diabetes

Oncology infrastructure, long-treatment duration and high unmet need support multiple defensible demand pools.

Oncology radioligands

Pluvicto +43% in 2025

US\$2.81bn

Combined 2025 sales of Pluvicto and Lutathera; growth is coupled to isotope production, patient imaging and licensed treatment capacity.



Somatostatin analogues

Durable branded demand

US\$1.21bn

Sandostatin remained a billion-dollar class anchor, while complex depot and device manufacture constrained easy substitution.



Fertility hormones

Pergoveris mix shift

€1.46bn

Merck's 2025 fertility franchise was stable overall, with combination-product growth offsetting decline in legacy Gonal-f.



Rare disease growth

Voxzogo +26%

US\$927m

Vosoritide reached 55 commercial markets, illustrating how specialist diagnosis and long treatment can scale a rare-disease peptide.



Recent approvals validate oral delivery, weekly dosing and new specialist targets

Events are jurisdiction-specific; US, EU and China approvals do not establish South African registration.

2025

28 JAN

Ozempic

US CKD risk-reduction label expansion.

INDICATION EXPANSION

27 JUN

Mazdutide

China obesity approval for dual glucagon/GLP-1 agonist.

NEW PRODUCT

15 AUG

Wegovy injection

US accelerated approval for MASH with fibrosis.

NEW INDICATION

19 SEP

Forzinity

First US-approved treatment for Barth syndrome.

RARE DISEASE

2026

05 JAN

Wegovy pill

US launch of the first oral GLP-1 for weight management.

ORAL FORMAT

27 FEB

Yuviwel

Weekly CNP therapy approved in the US for eligible children.

WEEKLY DOSING

18 MAR

ICOTYDE

First FDA-approved IL-23R-targeted oral peptide.

NEW MODALITY

26 MAR

Awikli

First US once-weekly basal insulin approval.

WEEKLY INSULIN

The next value wave is concentrated near filing and in differentiated Phase 3 assets

Commercial relevance rises with regulatory proximity—but none of these products had approved demand at the research cut-off.

Pipeline ≠ product: trial results, licensing value and online interest must not be represented as regulatory approval or lawful supply.

Under review / filed Closest potential catalysts CagriSema Amylin + semaglutide; US obesity application submitted. HIGH PROSPECTIVE Lu-177 edotreotide GEP-NET radioligand; FDA accepted NDA. NEAR-TERM CATALYST	Registration package Filing preparation Retatrutide Triple agonist; Lilly planned US filing in Q1 2027. STRONGEST SIGNAL	Phase 3 Differentiated metabolic assets Survodutide Obesity, MASLD and MASH programme. MariTide Monthly peptide–antibody conjugate. Efruxifermin FGF21 analogue for MASH. Pegozafermin FGF21 analogue under Roche.	Confirmatory path Additional evidence required Apraglutide Weekly GLP-2 analogue; confirmatory Phase 3 required. Early metabolic deals GUB014295, HS-20094 and Metsera assets show strategic buyer demand—not end-user demand.
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Lawful consumer categories must be separated from grey-market attention

The same word—“peptide”—can describe a food ingredient, cosmetic active, approved medicine or unapproved compound.

Defensible opportunity screens

Potentially lawful when classification, safety, claims and supply controls are satisfied.

Hydrolysed collagen peptides

Strongest evidenced non-drug demand; food, beverage, sports-nutrition and supplement uses.

TRACEABILITY + CLAIMS GATE

Topical cosmetic peptides

Established mass and premium skincare visibility; therapeutic claims can change classification.

COSMETIC SAFETY GATE

Approved prescription products

Commercially relevant only through registered products, licensed channels and authorised suppliers.

SAHPRA + LICENCE GATE

High-risk attention signals

Visibility, seizures and influencer promotion do not establish safety, efficacy or lawful demand.

BPC-157 and TB-500

Unapproved recovery/performance market with enforcement, quality and anti-doping exposure.

AVOID / HOLD

CJC-1295 and ipamorelin

Informal anti-ageing and bodybuilding promotion; significant safety-information gaps.

AVOID / HOLD

Melanotan and “research” retatrutide

Unapproved online products; pipeline publicity is not a legal commercial pathway.

AVOID / HOLD

Decision rule: popularity is never a substitute for product classification, authorisation, quality evidence or a lawful marketing claim.

Global popularity should enter George's portfolio only after five local gates

The commercial screen must begin with intended use and legal classification—not with supplier availability.

Product-to-market decision funnel

1. Define the exact product

Active, formulation, brand, manufacturer and intended claim

2. Confirm South African status

SAHPRA register, classification, indication and licence requirements

3. Qualify the source

Authorised manufacturer, GDP/GMP evidence and supply continuity

4. Validate operations

Import route, testing, cold chain, pharmacovigilance and recalls

5. Prove economics

Landed cost, channel margin, working capital and demand evidence

Prescription / clinician channel

Use only registered products, authorised indications and licensed supply routes. Partnerships may be more realistic than independent importation.

Cosmetic and food channels

Keep claims within the correct category; substantiate safety, source traceability, labelling and ingredient compliance.

Research channel

Verify institutional non-clinical use. "Research use only" wording cannot disguise promotion for human treatment or wellness.

SAHPRA warning signal

GLP-1 demand has attracted compounded, substandard and falsified products. Foreign approval or online availability is not a South African commercial permission.

Select a small, lawful portfolio before building a broad peptide catalogue

The next 90 days should convert the global opportunity map into product-specific South African decisions.

ACTION	OWNER	TIMING
Shortlist 8–12 candidates across prescription partnership, collagen and topical cosmetic screens Record exact product, claim, target customer and evidence for demand.	Commercial + Clinical	Days 1–15
Complete classification, SAHPRA and licence review before supplier negotiation Separate registered medicines, cosmetics, foods/supplements and institutional research products.	Regulatory + Legal	Days 1–30
Qualify suppliers and operating controls for the surviving candidates Verify quality agreements, testing, import pathway, cold chain, recalls and continuity.	Quality + Procurement	Days 16–60
Approve only products with lawful channels and viable landed economics Run pilot quantities; measure sell-through, service level, expiry and cash conversion.	Finance + Steering Group	Days 61–90

Prioritise

Evidence-backed, registered or clearly classified products with qualified sources.

Partner

Use authorised clinical, pharmacy, distribution and manufacturing capabilities where complexity is high.

Hold

Unapproved grey-market compounds and pipeline molecules until lawful status is established.